SCIENCE DEPARTMENT • SCIENCE LITERACY & LESSON INTERNALIZATION

PD AGENDA

Strengthening Science Literacy: Calibrating Writing Benchmarks, Feedback, and Revision

Strategy Focus: Teaching Students to Analyze Science Texts With CUBS + CER — calibrate a student-facing path from source analysis to an evidence-based response, feedback, and revision.

WEDNESDAY, OCTOBER 28, 2026 • 2:30–3:30 P.M. **60 MINUTES** **GRADES 9–12 SCIENCE • BRING FORMS & EVIDENCE**

TODAY'S OUTCOME Leave with a calibrated, ready-to-teach CUBS/CER routine; shared expectations for the writing benchmark and mastery bar; student directions; a feedback/revision action; and a plan to collect writing for Friday.

WHY THIS PLC MATTERS Teams need shared expectations for what the writing benchmark requires, what quality looks like, and how feedback will lead to revision. CUBS and color-coded CER make the source-analysis and explanation moves visible while students remain responsible for the thinking.

PROTOCOL CONNECTION
Every Day Questions 1, 3, and 4; Team Deep Dive Steps 2–4: clarify the benchmark and mastery bar, anticipate student responses and access needs, and calibrate the student experience, feedback, and revision moves.

WHAT TO BRING
One course-specific science article, text set, data display, model, investigation prompt, or constructed-response task; current standard(s); student-facing materials or a draft; highlighters in CER colors; Lesson Internalization Tool; and laptop/planning materials.

FOCUS TO PROTECT
The shared Biology benchmark is a model for calibrating expectations. Every science teacher adapts CUBS and color-coded CER to an authentic course task. The routine supports students in doing the task; it is not an additional grading system.

TODAY'S PLC PLAN

TIME (MIN)	FOCUS	WHAT TO DO	PRODUCT / CHECK
2:30–2:35	**Establish a shared calibration focus**	Connect Monday's benchmark experience and Tuesday's planning to a shared writing benchmark, success criteria, feedback, revision, and student-facing literacy routines.	**Purpose**
2:35–2:41	**Calibrate the full instructional cycle**	Trace the path from experiencing the task to planning learning, teaching CUBS/CER, reading completed writing, providing feedback, and responding to evidence.	**Learning arc**
2:41–2:50	**Model CUBS**	Think aloud how students circle the main idea, underline supporting details, box high-leverage vocabulary, and summarize/record questions.	**Source analysis**
2:50–3:00	**Practice CUBS on a science source**	Use the Biology food web/Question 5 or another shared visual/text to identify what students need to notice before they write.	**Practice**
3:00–3:08	**Calibrate color-coded CER**	Make claim, evidence, reasoning, and linking language visible in a science response; identify what students must make visible to meet the mastery bar.	**Response analysis**
3:08–3:15	**Calibrate feedback + revision**	Plan modeling, prompts, practice, written feedback, and a revision action that keep students responsible for the scientific explanation.	**Feedback loop**
3:15–3:28	**Protected course-alike calibration + application**	Adapt CUBS/CER to one authentic course task. Calibrate student directions, a model/anchor, success criteria, and a feedback/revision opportunity.	**Ready-to-teach plan**
3:28–3:30	**Close + collect writing**	Teach the routine, collect a small de-identified set of completed writing and feedback/revision evidence, and bring it Friday for mastery analysis.	**Friday bridge**

PROTECTED INDIVIDUAL WORK WITH COLLEAGUE SUPPORT

WORK WITH COLLEAGUES

WHAT TO DO Calibrate the student-facing routine independently first. Then use colleagues to check that the benchmark/task, mastery bar, directions, model, feedback prompt, student revision action, and evidence check preserve the intended science and literacy demand.

1. **Calibrate the benchmark:** Clarify the task, success criteria, and evidence students must make visible.
2. **Model CUBS:** Make source-analysis moves visible before students write.
3. **Calibrate CER colors:** Help students see the claim, evidence, reasoning, and transitions in a response.
4. **Plan feedback + revision:** Write ready-to-use directions, a feedback prompt, and a revision action.
5. **Collect completed writing:** Use evidence Friday to provide feedback and plan a mastery next step.

USE THIS REFERENCE DURING GROUP WORK

CALIBRATE QUALITY BEFORE STUDENTS WRITE
Use the benchmark and mastery bar to agree on what students must notice, explain, and make visible in a complete response.

CUBS + COLOR-CODED CER MAKE THINKING VISIBLE
Students use CUBS to analyze the source and label their claim, evidence, and reasoning so they can see what is present, partial, missing, or not connected.

FEEDBACK MUST LEAD TO REVISION
Model the routine, prompt student analysis, and use a criterion-based feedback prompt that leads to a specific revision. Do not complete the science thinking.

COLLABORATION IN PRACTICE Protect time for thoughtful individual work; use respectful, student-centered feedback to make the next decision clearer.
TEACHER RUBRIC CONNECTION **Standard I: I-A-4 Well-Structured Lessons • Standard II: II-A-2 Student Engagement • Standard II: II-D-2 High Expectations • Standard IV: IV-C-1 Professional Collaboration**

